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MY POWAI

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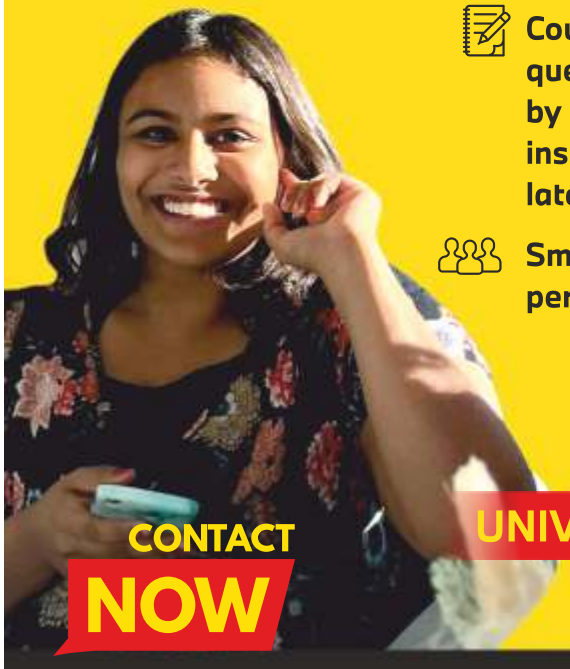

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Dear friends

July has brought us relentless rain, and with it, the potholes around Powai have become deeper and more treacherous. The commute from Chandivali to Powai has turned into a daily ordeal, testing the patience and resilience of many. We remain hopeful that August will usher in a much-needed dry spell, allowing for some critical patch work to restore our roads and make our commutes safer and smoother.

Despite the weather woes, we have some exciting content lined up for you this month. Chef Sudhir Pai has crafted two delightful yet healthy dishes that promise to tantalize your taste buds without compromising on nutrition.

In addition, our Nutritionist has penned an informative piece on managing migraines - a common ailment that affects many of us. Her practical tips and advice can help you find relief and improve your overall well-being. Don't forget to turn to our astro page for your monthly predictions.

As always, we have a roundup of local news to keep you updated on the latest happenings in our neighborhood.

We welcome your comments and suggestions, so please feel free to share your thoughts with us.

Regards
Mahesh Kutty
(Editor)

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If you see or experience any act of injustice in our locality please report to us: mypowai@yahoo.in

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Powai Udyan gets makeover

D.P.K. Udas

On Saki ViharRoad, opposite Navnath Mandir there is Powai Udyan. It is also known as Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar Powai Udyan.

This garden is in existence for long time. It is at West end of Powai Lake. It also houses Water Dept of BMC.

Earlier the garden was in shambles and not properly maintained. Later BMC had given improvement contract and now accessible to Public since May 2024.

The number of improvements has been done.

1) Floating fountain: As soon as one enters garden there is floating fountain. Small reservoir has been constructed and floating fountain adjusts as per water level.

2) Pathways and Parapet: They have constructed all pathways and tiles fixed. There is concrete railing throughout. This prevents visitors from going to plantation

portion.

3) Railings: The railings have been erected at different places making place safe and also as support for elderly.

4) Umbrella: There is giant concrete umbrella for sit out so that visitors can sit and enjoy Powai Lake breeze.

5) Lake View Point: This is best point of Udyan. One can see Powai dam, large lake and skyline of Hiranandani Gardens. Standing here gives us good view of the nature. Greenery all around.
The dam was built in 1891. It has been 133 years and it is still standing and bearing water pressure all the time.
Structural audit has been done in 2019.

6) Fishing Club: At the end of garden there is "Maharashtra State Angling Association" (MSAA). They are also popularly known as boat club. Though it is called angling association they undertake lot of environmental activities.
Conservation of the Great Indian Mahseer
Research activities with fisheries dept.
Removal of Water Hyacinth infestation.
Water quality analysis.

7) North end of the Garden: The North end of the garden is part of Sanjay Gandhi National Park.
There is small hill at this end Paradise for botany students.

8) Light Fittings: New light fittings have been installed so that garden is illuminated at night time. However, garden is open from 6.30 am to 7 pm. It is ideal place for morning walk. Visitors are not allowed at night.

9) New Plantation proposed: Earlier garden is having trees which survive on rain water and ground water. Now new plantation is proposed. Particularly of flowering plants. The pipe line has been laid to water them.

The garden is going to look more beautiful in 2-3 months from now. However, it is worth the visit even today.

(The author is long time resident of Powai. He takes up civic issues with the authorities. He has been instrumental in improving illumination in the area, zebra crossings , garbage removal etc.)

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Re-visiting our heritage of learning & knowledge sharing

As Mark Twain once said, “India is the cradle of human race, the birthplace of human speech, the mother of history, the grandmother of legend, and great grandmother of tradition. Our most valuable and most instructive materials in the history of man are treasured up in India only.”

Since antiquity, Indians have treasured their collective wisdom, above all, in various books and scriptures. Repeated over the centuries by thousands of Muni-Rishis and millions of students thru chanting, these stockpiles of knowledge were handed down from one generation to the next. In the later ages they were captured in written form as Vedas, Puranas, Upanishads, Sutras & Samhitas.

During Vedic period the students in groups stayed at ashramas attached to one or more Gurus until their education was completed. The Gurukulas were the earliest known Residential Schools anywhere in the world. In the Medieval ages some of these Gurukulas became larger and larger to be recognized as universities. These Universities were established and supported by the lords, Kings and Emperors of the time.

India has been home to numerous ancient and medieval universities with a proud history. Known for the advance level of Learning and Knowledge Sharing, Scholars from across the world came to Study, Research and even Teach at these Universities. India was truly the Knowledge Center of the world.

Takshashila, one of the oldest universitieswas established in the 6th Century BC and flourished for several centuries. Nalanda University had been the one of the largest universities in the world in the mediaeval ages. It had over 10,000 students and 1,500 teachers from different countries and religion. Universities of Vikramshila, Odantapuri, Sompura, Vallabhi, Jagaddala, Bikrampur, Pushpagiri, Sharad Peth and the list goes on.

One of the attractions at all these Universities were their Libraries and the collection of Books. The legendary library of Nalanda and it’s eventual burning down by the invaders is well known. Interestingly from the Gurukulas to these Universities, everywhere Education was FREE! No Fees were charged. Students however had to prove their merit thru rigorous Entrance Test(s), some of which would put today’s exams to shame.

Now why this sudden interest in History. Well because this is one Story that makes every Indian proud and reminds us of our duty to support the Education Systems and Institutes in whatever way we can. And this is why Spandan Foundation of Mumbai has taken up the theme of तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमयor prayer of “Lead me From Darkness to Light” for their 12th Powai Sharadotsav, to be held from 08th to 13th October 2024 at the Spandan Durga Puja ground, Powai.

Spandan Foundation, which has always been at the forefront of Innovative design and Parallel Thinking when it’s comes to Socio-Cultural Events, has been celebrating Powai Sharadotsav as a Festival with a Purpose. Conducted during the festival of Durga, it dishes out year on year a colorful kaleidoscope of Cultural Events, innovative Pandals, delicious Food and endless Fun. But all these is done with the purpose of highlighting a Cause.

Spandan CARES, the philanthropic arm of the Foundation, has been working on providing Education and Learning Support for the under privileged class of the Society. It supports various Schools and Training centers in educating such students and grooming young minds.

So what are they planning for this year’s Sharadotsav? Please watch this space as the Story unfolds!

Badminton tournament in Raheja Vihar

In July, the Raheja Clubhouse buzzed with excitement as 36 participants gathered for a thrilling badminton tournament. The event brought together players of all skill levels for a day of friendly competition and community spirit.

Matches kicked off early, with the clubhouse badminton court filled with fast-paced rallies and enthusiastic cheers. One of the highlights was a nail-biting final between Vrijesh Poojari and Rajat Sharma, who edged out a win in a tense game in the Group A Men's Doubles final. In the Group B Men's Doubles, Janmajay Chauhan and Ashish Kumar triumphed, while Aritra Sarkar and Sonalee Sarkar secured victory in the Mixed Doubles category.

The semi-finals were equally exciting. In the Group A Men's Doubles, Vrijesh Poojari and Rajat Sharma faced off against Raveesh Shrivastava and Vivek Shah. In the Group B Men's Doubles, Janmajay Chauhan and Ashish Kumar competed against Prashant Pandey and Anshul Tanvar. In the Mixed Doubles, Aritra Sarkar and Sonalee Sarkar went up against Raveesh Shrivastava and Samiya Karmarkar.

The day wrapped up with a small award ceremony, celebrating not just the winners, but all participants for their effort and sportsmanship.

Evergreen Karaoke singing group organizes monsoon session

'Evergreen Karaoke Singing Group' Powai organized a Monsoon Session on 20th July in 'Let's Sing' studio in Saki Vihar. Ironically, 20 singers participated in the Monsoon Session. The incessant rains didn't deter the singers from reaching on time, with some of them coming from the outer Powai area in the wet weather. The age group of singers ranged from 50 to 80 years, and as the name of the group suggests, they sang enthusiastically.

The preparations began only a fortnight ago, with the tracks of the songs selected by members being sent to the studio owner Manoj Dev. The songs were from the era of the 60s to the 90s, including "Babuji Dheere Chalna," "Khoya Khoya Chand," "Sama Hai Suhana Suhana," "Adha Hai Chandrama," "Awara Aye Mere Dil," "Bhari Duniya Mein Akhir," "Hosh Walon Ko Kya Khabar," "Aaj Kal Tere Mere," "Kehna Hai Kehna Hai," "Aaj Jane Ki Zid," "Chaand Si Mehbooba," and "Tere Sur Aur Mere Geet," amongst others. The studio was well-equipped for the sound effects. There was a tea break with hot tea and snacks to keep the vocal cords and energy levels elevated.

A senior member explained the nuances of karaoke singing. Historically speaking, karaoke started in Kobe, Japan, around 1971. Restaurants would lease the machines for their patrons, who would sing into the microphone, oblivious of the time. 'Karaoke' is derived from two Japanese words: 'Kara' comes from the word 'Karappo' meaning empty or void, and 'oke' comes from the word 'okesutura' or orchestra. Shigelchi Negish, the entrepreneur, invented the world's first karaoke machine in 1967. The 'Sparks Box' prototype is among other machines credited to him for ushering in Japan's karaoke craze, which makes people unwind and feel relaxed, uninhibited, and creates lasting memories.

In yet another instance, there was no orchestra available in a restaurant, so the patrons were invited to sing instead. Asia is known to be the karaoke capital of the world. Powai's 'Evergreen Karaoke Singing Group' members meet once a month for musical sessions. To join, contact organizer Bhupendra Shah at mobile 9324662290.

- Preeti Oka

Powai resident wins Mumbai Monsoon Marathon

Pooja Jain, a resident of Powai, participated in the Mumbai Monsoon Marathon on July 7th at Lands End, Bandra.

The event saw around 1,000 participants across various age categories, creating a vibrant and competitive atmosphere.

Pooja competed in the 45-55 age category. The race kicked off at 6 am, with enthusiastic spectators lining the route to cheer on the runners. Hydration stations were strategically placed along the course, ensuring all participants stayed refreshed and energized. The event was exceptionally well organised.

Despite having participated in numerous marathons before, this was Pooja's first experience with the Mumbai Monsoon Marathon.

Pooja's previous races have seen her come close to securing a podium finish, but this time, she surpassed her past performances and clinched the first prize in her category.

The victory was a testament to her dedication, training, and perseverance, marking a memorable milestone in her marathon journey.

Homeless and heartbroken: stories from the streets

Chaarvi Athawale

Powai has been known for its many attractions: picturesque gardens, the lush verdure, the prestigious IIT campus, bustling crowds, lively fests. This time, however, Powai is gaining notoriety for entirely different reasons: uprooting homes, disrupting communities and displacing people. Think you might have read that wrong? The makeshift shanties and poorly put-together tents on the streets of Powai, hunching under the downpour of rain, will make you think again.

Powai's Jai Bhim Nagar was razed by authorities a month ago, on grounds that the demolition was an anti-encroachment drive. The slum dwellers had been issued a notice asking them to vacate the premises within a mere period of 48 hours . Dwellers were not given an opportunity to collect their belongings, even a day after their houses were taken down. Important documents like birth certificates and identification cards were lost among the debris and remains. The situation remains precarious, as things have taken a violent turn in the past with the dwellers hurling stones at authorities, who were then compelled to respond with a lathi charge.

What now? The residents have taken to the Powai footpaths and are living under make-do shelters with nothing but a plastic sheet to protect them from the heavy rains. The monsoon season has added fat to the fire, making it unhygienic for everyone in the area, passers-by and residents alike. Mossy roads and dripping water have started attracting mosquitoes, making sleep hell for those spending nights under the shanties. Children are falling ill, people are defecating in the open due to the limited number of mobile toilets, and the area is getting increasingly contaminated and inhumane for these individuals to continue living like they are.

Where do we go from here? How can we as Powaikars help alleviate the cruelty of these circumstances?

Organizing community drives to collect essential items like clothes, blankets, food, and toiletries can provide immediate relief to those affected. Powaikars can help to donate resources or funds to support these efforts.

The health and hygiene of the displaced are at serious risk, especially with the ongoing monsoon season. Setting up medical camps with the help of local hospitals and clinics can provide much-needed medical care. Volunteers, including doctors and nurses, can offer free health check-ups, and distribute essential medicines to prevent the spread of diseases.

In collaboration with NGOs and local authorities, we can work towards setting up more secure and weather-resistant temporary shelters. Community halls, or other covered public spaces can be repurposed temporarily to provide safer living conditions for the displaced families until permanent solutions are found.

Many slum dwellers lost important documentation during the demolition. Providing legal aid and assistance in retrieving or reissuing documents like birth certificates, identification cards, and ration cards can help them regain access to essential services and rights.

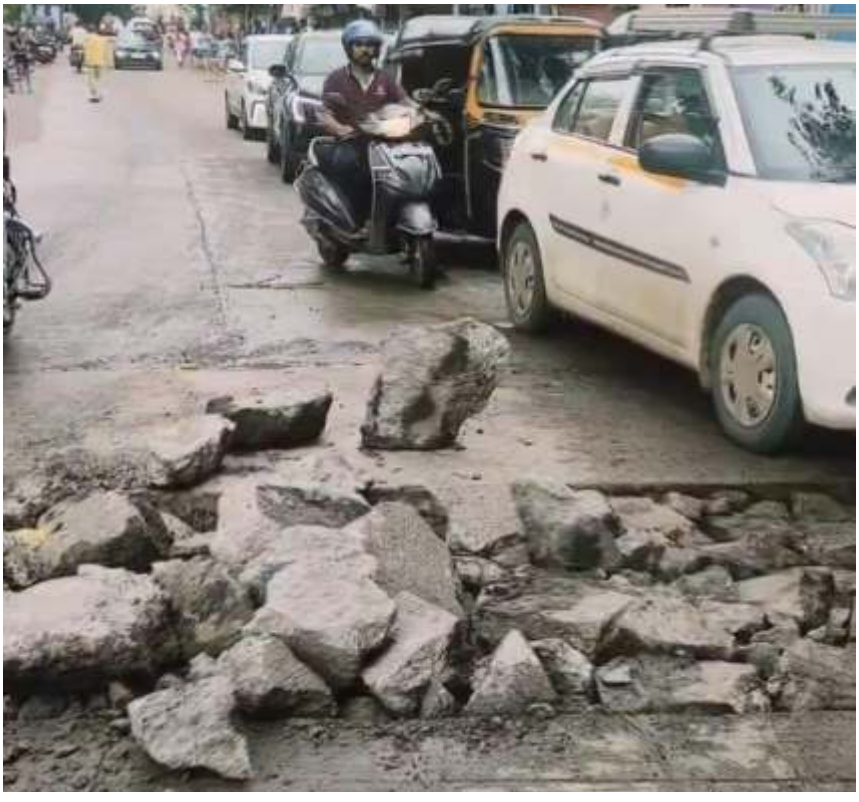
While immediate relief is crucial, advocating for long-term solutions such as affordable housing projects and proper rehabilitation plans is equally important. As Powaikars, we have the power to make a meaningful difference. By coming together and taking action, we can help our displaced friends through this crisis and work towards a more just and compassionate community. Let us help them today, so that we all can have a better tomorrow.

The nightmare of potholes and encroachments in Powai during the rains

Powai, a bustling suburb in the heart of Mumbai, is renowned for its picturesque lake, modern infrastructure, and vibrant community. However, come monsoon season, this otherwise charming locality transforms into a nightmare for its residents and commuters. The primary culprits? Potholes and encroachments exacerbate the woes of those navigating the area during the rains.

Potholes in Powai are a perennial issue, but the monsoon rains turn them into hazardous traps. The heavy downpour not only deepens existing potholes but also creates new ones. These craters in the road are often concealed by rainwater, making them invisible to drivers and pedestrians alike. The consequences are dire. Vehicles frequently suffer damage when they hit these hidden potholes, leading to broken suspensions, flat tires, and misaligned wheels. The already congested roads become even more clogged as vehicles slow down to navigate the treacherous terrain, resulting in long traffic jams and delays. The risk of accidents increases manifold, with motorists swerving abruptly to avoid potholes, leading to collisions. For pedestrians, navigating waterlogged streets with hidden potholes often results in slips, falls, and injuries.

Encroachments are another critical issue plaguing Powai, particularly during the monsoon season. Unauthorized constructions and illegal stalls encroach upon sidewalks and roads, reducing the space available for vehicles and pedestrians. Encroachments block natural drainage channels, leading to waterlogging. Streets turn into mini-lakes, making commuting daunting and increasing the risk of waterborne diseases. The already narrow roads become even more constricted, exacerbating traffic snarls and leading to gridlocks. Pedestrians are forced onto the roads, putting them at risk of being hit by vehicles. The lack of proper sidewalks is dangerous for children, the elderly, and people with disabilities. During emergencies, encroachments hinder the movement of ambulances, fire trucks, and other emergency services, potentially putting lives at risk.



Addressing the issues of potholes and encroachments requires a multi-pronged approach. Regular maintenance checks can prevent the formation of new potholes. Strict action against illegal encroachments is essential, with regular anti-encroachment drives to reclaim public spaces and ensure smooth traffic flow. Upgrading the drainage infrastructure can mitigate waterlogging, reducing road damage and preventing potholes. Community involvement can play a crucial role in maintaining the area's infrastructure. There should be transparency in the allocation and utilization of funds for road repairs, with accountability mechanisms to ensure efficient and effective work.

Powai's transformation from a serene suburb to a chaotic nightmare during the rains highlights the urgent need for infrastructure improvements. Potholes and encroachments not only disrupt daily life but also pose serious safety risks. By addressing these issues through proactive measures and community involvement, Powai can reclaim its charm and provide a safer, smoother experience for its residents and visitors, even during the monsoon season.

- Anushka Bahorey
Singapore International School
Grade 10

How to navigate your child's anxiety

Debika Chaudhuri

How often have you seen your child getting anxious or depressed and find yourself feeling the same? Maybe you've tried telling your child, "It's okay, don't worry, why don't go out, you will feel better?"

Both these methods don't help your child overcome their anxiety or depression. As a parent it is very natural for you to be unhappy when your child is unhappy or for you to be pained when you see your child in pain. However, reacting emotionally rather than responding thoughtfully isn't helpful.

When you tell your child to ignore the pain and go out instead, you are trying to control what the child should or should not feel. You may be doing this with good intention, however, you are teaching your child "display rules" – implicit rules of what emotions your family is okay with and what emotions the child should not show. As your child grows up, and comes home feeling pained, deep inside they believe they should not show you the pain and so resort to means of isolating themselves, so they can avoid showing you their emotions.

When you ask your child questions, such as, "How long have you been feeling this way?" You are taking two actions:
1. You are distancing your own emotions from your child's, and not getting hooked to it or overwhelmed by it. If both of you are in pain, you can't help your child to get into a better emotional space.
2. You are helping your child understand it is okay to feel the way they are feeling, and encourage them to explore their emotions.

You could follow up that question with a few more such as:

"What would you like to do about it?"
"How would you like to feel an hour from now?"
"What actions would you need to take to feel that way in another hour?"

These questions allow your child to think about the emotion and also think of solutions to navigate it. So, instead of brooding, you are empowering your child and helping your child regulate their emotions.

Think of emotional agility like yoga. Just as yogis need a strong core to be flexible, parents need to be emotionally grounded to respond to their child's needs. This means being in touch with and understanding your own emotions.

Have you ever stood at the airport que and suddenly felt restless? Looking the personnel at the desks checking people in, you felt like lashing out at them to hurry up! Have you analysed what emotion triggers this restlessness? Is standing at the que, making you feel bored? Does that boredom then trigger a sense of urgency in you to move and do something more interesting? Then do you begin thinking how slow the personnel at the desk is and how inefficient they are? Does that slowly create annoyance and frustration within you? Do you maybe call someone and and vent out your emotions at them? If you deep dive into your emotions, you will begin to see a pattern of how the external environment creates emotions within you which in turn trigger certain thoughts that ultimately manifest in certain behaviour.

Accept emotions as being helpful to us. They are telling us something. There are no good or bad emotions, positive or negative emotions. Emotions are a means of survival for us. Since ancient times emotions told us to beware of the wild animals or dangers lurking outside our caves so that we could protect ourselves. It's the same primeval instinct that acts when you stand at the que and get bored. You need to be able to acknowledge this and navigate it. Identify where in the body are you getting impacted? Are you tapping your foot, is your heart beating faster? Touch your heart and say, I am getting bored at the que because I am used to constantly doing something. Tell yourself it is okay to feel bored, however, what can you do about it? Ask yourself how would you like to feel in an hour? Irritable from this experience, or looking forward to the journey and your destination? What actions could you take so that you begin feeling excited instead of being irritable? You may come up with a few answers. You could read a book from kindle, or check your mails, or social media, maybe you could just talk to the person next to you. You have not dismissed your boredom, but actually acknowledged it's presence and set a goal for your emotions in an hour from now.

We are all untethered with our emotions, more so after the pandemic. We can choose to play the victim, be stubborn, attempt at controlling the situation outside, or, we can choose to navigate our emotions and develop our core, connect with the reality of our emotions.

(The author, Debika Chaudhuri, runs Elzix Foundation, an Educational Consultancy for the past twelve years. She has studied across three continents and has close to three decades of experience as an Executive Educator and Career Coach. She and her team help young people make important choices at critical junctures of their lives; develop self-confidence, if they don't know what to do; help develop their skills to make the right fit; create life-changing educational experiences and help them with college admissions. She may be reached at debika@elzixfoundation.com)

Stories in and around homes

Girija Menon

It was supposed to be a simple lunch with someone who is like a mom. A rainy day in Mumbai, overcast and cloudy. Nevertheless, an appointment must be honored; this one was my pleasure.

Post lunch was a visit to say hi to an acquaintance but a dear friend of my sister-in-law. She was keen I visit this friend's home for reasons more than one.

An artist couple, creative and a space where art and creativity start from the gate that opens into a house, a vibe from there embraces you warmly, at least for someone like me who loves creating and appreciating art in any form.

A suburb in Mumbai, a quaint street that leads you to this house that on this rainy day seemed like it was tucked under the shade of greens that have grown from sides to center as if protecting and blessing the house in a way, only the universe can because it's like a sprinkler where wellness drops from heaven.

The gate with brass antique plaques on either side opens into a pathway with plants, creepers, flora, and fauna in every shape, size, and shade possible. Huge lamps placed strategically on either side cannot be missed, despite it being a cloudy overcast day. One can't help but stand there, touch them, admire them, and maybe whisper a sweet nothing to the leaves that seem to say 'welcome' in their unique way.

A door that opens into a seating area where just one look is all one needs to get hooked. Be it the painting on the wall, a sculpture sitting on the corner table, lamps in every size, shape, and contour, the center table with slots beneath the glass that have tiny bits of history placed for them to rest comfortably, the masks and so much more that I stood there wanting to touch and feel them all. Touching them somehow felt like touching a page in history, a craftsman's palm, or just an energy that comes from an antique that we call inanimate, yet silently narrates a story which for us is to interpret and absorb.

A studio room with canvas piled up against the wall waiting for the artist to bring a brush doused in paint that will in take a course from their heart to mind and mind to fingertips, and in time forms strokes, lines, curves, dots, figures, and eventually a masterpiece. Time, patience, imagination, and a connection between the artist and that white canvas are like a new life born to bloom and touch hearts, minds, and souls for a very long time.

I was led to a stairway that took me to the level on the first floor. The walls had a pair of ancient breastplates, the set of lamps on the landing looked like a family, standing there to welcome with a positive vibe and up there was much more than I expected. So glad to be here!

The books in shelves neatly arranged, nooks that housed a whole lot of antiques in figures, kettles, urns, platters, idols, and plenty more. The glassware with a story behind each one of them and in shades – reds, pinks, sea green, blue, orange, whites, and also a mix of shades merged skillfully in glass art …..until my eyes hit the ceiling. Chandeliers, a crescent moon, and a star under which I stood awestruck in the literal sense. Am I in a real world or is this a dream? Still figuring it out.

Life threads here for me were silent heartbeats from every antique piece, glassware, and the display of lamps that in a way whispers into my ears – "History goes nowhere, it just weaves stories, poetries and adds rhythm into the present, taking history to the future because it stays in this universe forever – long after you and I have vacated our seats here.

(Girija Menon, the author, enjoys her passion for writing. Her first love is poetry; an astute observer of the world around us, she loves writing down her thoughts in both poems and prose. LIFE THREADS is what she uses to weave this one-of-a-kind fabric that spans reams. She can be reached at – whisperingverses@gmail.com)

Wellness wisdom from around the world

Hara Hachi Bun Me

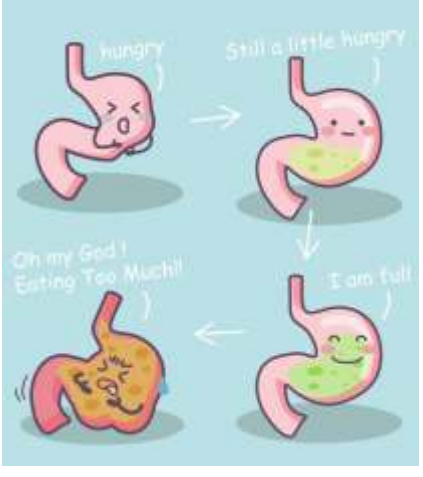
Palak Sardana

The divide between the haves and the have-nots in this world has always been wide. While one end of the spectrum remains unchanged with severe deprivation, the affluent end faces its own unique challenges of excesses in every age. The affluence that earlier belonged to a select few, with unprecedented advancement in technology, is now available to many more who are experiencing it with a sense of awe for the first time. One of these excesses is the easy availability of food. Available any time, any place just by a few swipes on the smart phone.

Man's relationship with food is one of the oldest and perhaps the most intense as it is the very source of survival. It is deep-rooted in our psyche and has been passed on efficiently by our ancestors who once lived in the jungles. Edible foods (sweet ones more so) were rare and hard to come-by, hence food formed the core of primitive man's pursuit. This hard-wiring is visible even in a new-born who has no other skill but knows how to cry out aloud when hungry.

To cope with the periods when food could not be found, bodies of early humans adapted efficient storage systems to store the surplus in the form of glycogen and fat. What worked efficiently then, is turning out to be a bane for the affluent societies. While we continue to mirror the sophisticated storage mechanisms of our ancestors and like them, have an affinity towards sweet foods & insecurity with regards to unavailability of food, our outer environment has radically changed. On one hand, calorie dense foods are abundantly available (courtesy crafty marketeers who understand the desires of our primitive brains better than us), while on the other, the comforts & efficiency of modern living has reduced our energy needs significantly compared to that of our ancestors. Advertising, pop-ups, deals, vending machines, clever placements in supermarkets all ensure that we do not escape the lure of the sweet and the fat.

Since man's fascination with food is nothing new and is universal in nature, every culture came up with their own techniques entrenched in science and psychology to avoid excessive consumption. One such concept is 'hara hachi bun me'. Though the book Ikigai made it popular as a Japanese concept, its origin is actually in the Confucian philosophy. It essentially means to eat until 80% full. This rule doesn't prohibit one from eating, but only indicates at stopping short of when one starts to feel full. Psychologically it doesn't lead to any feeling of deprivation while scientifically it facilitates proper digestion.



Full stomach inhibits digestion as there is no space for the ingested food to move and mix up properly with the digestive enzymes. It also puts pressure on the surrounding organs. The tendency of 'eating to full capacity' makes the stomach accommodate more food than needed, increases the appetite over a period of time eventually leading to weight gain and paving way for maladies like type 2 diabetes, fatty liver etc.

Many studies have linked the practice of hara hachi bun me to lower BMI and increased longevity. Okinawa, an archipelago in Japan is one of the blue zones where people tend to live healthiest and longest. This philosophy is followed diligently by its inhabitants, and they utter it as a mantra before every meal to be mindful of when to stop eating.

Similar wisdom can be found in yogic and ayurvedic literature too. Practice of mitahar (moderation in food) focuses on filling half the stomach with solid food, 1/4th with liquids (like chhaas, soups, herbal teas) and leaving 1/4th empty. The idea again is to facilitate efficient digestion.

However, for someone initiating the practice, the challenge can be to ascertain how to know if one is 80% full. Though the practice is intuitive in nature, the beginners can use tactics like eating in smaller plates or reducing the regularly consumed portion sizes by 20% (1.5 chapatis instead of 2). The other way is to eat slowly. Chewing thoroughly and savoring each morsel allows the mind enough time (typically it takes 15-20 minutes) to register the feeling of fullness. The concept works with calorie counters too since over a period of time, it creates a calorie deficit leading to weight loss without really compromising on food choices and routines.

In his bestseller Atomic Habits, James Clear emphasizes the importance of bringing in simple and tiny changes in daily routines that do not require any substantial effort to sustain. At the same time, capable of producing tremendous results when practiced consistently over a period of time.

Hara hachi bun me perfectly fits the bill as it doesn't require any special effort, equipment, place or time. All it needs is self-love and a little mindfulness!

(Palak Sardana is an internationally certified wellness coach, psychological counsellor, yoga teacher & founder of wellness venture, Tranquility Unlimited. Her endeavor is to present workable & practical models of wellness from ancient wisdom and modern scientific research via these articles. She runs ongoing wellness classes. For joining or booking a personalized consultation/session, write to tranquilityunlimited@gmail.com)

What is Pediatric Dentistry?

- Dr Vaishali Prasad

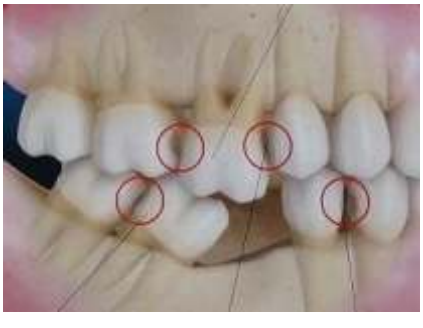
Does the phrase “Just remove it” sound familiar when thinking about a painful tooth ? Well, it’s the most unwise thing to do. Why? Because there are consequences when you lose a tooth. We understand that some teeth have a hopeless prognosis and must be removed. We’re not talking about cases where extraction is the only option and you opt to replace the missing tooth with a dental implant. The consequences that we are referring to are those of removing a tooth and not replacing it.

Every single tooth in your mouth is important and has a specific function.
Hence, front and back teeth, alike, need to be replaced promptly to avoid further tooth loss and other potential issues. Here’s more from your dentist about why you should not wait to replace a missing molar, alongwith why a dental implant is the best option for doing so.

Consequences of Missing Teeth
Shifting of Teeth
It is the presence of neighbouring and opposing teeth that maintains the position of the teeth. When a single tooth is missing, the neighbouring teeth will begin to lean (tilt) sideways and move (drift) toward the empty space, and the opposing tooth will move vertically farther (overerupt) into the empty space.

Increased Risk for Cavities
Overeruption causes some of the root to become exposed which decays faster than the crown. Overeruption also causes unevenness & spacing among the back teeth that trap debris. Unclean teeth cause inflammation of the surrounding gums. They decay more readily too.

Changes in the Bite



All of that shifting causes changes in the way upper and lower teeth bite together leading to TMJ problems, tooth sensitivity, gum recession, and cracked teeth. This shifting is harmful to the bite because teeth withstand the heavy chewing forces best from an angle that is parallel to their roots. When the tooth leans, the roots also lean, and then the biting force is no longer parallel to the root.

Changes in the Smile
The shifted and leaning teeth appear crooked and also result in small gaps beween the front teeth.

Increased Risk for Gum Recession

If a tooth is missing, the gum has no pressure from adjacent teeth and slowly recedes down the root.

Moreover, a tooth tilted over can develop a gum pocket along its forward root. Gum pockets are narrow, abnormal spaces that develop between the gums and the tooth root. The debris and bacteria that collect in a pocket lead to an ever-increasing inflammation of the gums adjacent to the pocket as also of the bone immediately adjacent to it. Inflamed bone softens and slowly begins to disappear.
Changes in bite forces also are an irritant to the gums and can cause recession, too.

Jawbone loss
Teeth maintain the strength and density of the jawbone. When you lose the tooth, the bone that once supported the tooth starts to resorb, leading to bone loss and jawbone weakening. Over time, this can cause further tooth loss and even changes in the facial structure

Increased Risk for Cracked Teeth
When bite forces hit a tooth at an inappropriate angle, the tooth is likely to crack under the stress.
A surface crack can cause sensitivity to hot or cold and pain on chewing. A more extensively cracked tooth may require root canal treatment or extraction.

Changes in facial appearance
Missing teeth cause the muscle ligaments in your face to weaken, resulting in sagging of facial tissue, thinning of lipsand the jawline can become less defined.

Inadequate Chewing Force
Our molars have large, wide chewing surfaces meant to grind food, which is an important first step in the process of digestion.
People missing multiple teeth often suffer from digestive problems and have a higher risk for choking on unchewed pieces of food.

How to Avoid these Consequences

Early replacement can help avoid the consequences of tooth loss.

Dentistry provides multiple options for tooth replacement but nothing beats a dental implant because it actually implants into your gum tissue and fuses with the jawbone to recreate the natural anatomy and functions of a real tooth as closely as possible and reduces the likelihood of these consequences.
Replacing a Missing Tooth today will avoid grief and greater expense tomorrow &Replacement with a Dental Implant always improves your Oral Health!

(Dr Vaishali Prasad, MDSis aPediatric& Implant Dentistpracticing at Dr LH Hiranandani Hospital, Powai and can be reached at +91 7738599062 drvaishaliprasad@hotmail.com)

Managing the migraine menace

Nisha Singh

Managing the Migraine Menace

Migraine, the word can trigger the memory of nightmarish experiences for many. Blinding and pulsating pain, aches which are often one sided, nausea, blurred vision, sensitivity to light and sound, the symptoms are wide and varied for every individual suffering from migraine. These episodes or "attacks" can be debilitating and can last from several hours to several days.

What causes a migraine has not yet been completely understood, but both genetics as well as lifestyle factors are considered to be the cause. Hormones, age, familial history, and gender are all risk factors.

For women, hormonal changes are often thought to be the primary trigger. Hormonal fluctuations especially of estrogen throughout their lifecycle can trigger migraines. Apart from this, sensory overload in terms of flashing and strong colourful lights, loud sounds and strong smells can also be the triggers. Excessive stress, changes in sleeping patterns, extreme physical exertion, and the most common, changes in weather and certain foods are all the other factors known to trigger migraine.

The following are some steps that can be taken to avoid or manage an episode of migraine.

- The foremost step is to identify your trigger. Though it's common advice and easier said than done, identifying what is the most common trigger goes a long way in avoiding and managing future episodes of migraine. It is important to remember that what factor triggers a migraine once may not necessarily trigger an episode again. It is therefore important to remember the most frequent causes.

- Skipping meals and remaining hungry for long periods of time can trigger migraines for many. Hence, it's advisable to avoid long gaps. Eat small frequent meals.

- Stay well hydrated and avoid fizzy or sugary drinks as a source of fluid. Dehydration can trigger and increase the intensity of a migraine headache. In fact, research shows that mild headaches are often a symptom of dehydration. Hydrate as per your daily requirement keeping in mind any water loss due to sweat caused by hot weather or exercise.

- Consume fresh, seasonal foods instead of processed foods. Packaged and processed foods contain additives such as MSG or monosodium glutamate that are known to trigger migraines. Instead ensure a variety of fresh fruits and vegetables in the diet. Also keep in mind to try and eat freshly cooked food as often as possible.

- Caffeine is a double-edged sword for many. Some experience relief during headaches and for some people caffeine is a trigger. Do not go overboard. The idea is to limit it to up to 2 cups a day.

- Wine and beer are also triggers for migraines. Though it may not happen every single time you consume it. Like caffeine it's best to limit it.

- Include a variety of seeds, nuts and dried fruits to get all the essential vitamins and minerals especially riboflavin, magnesium and omega 3 fatty acids. These are known to help in reducing the intensity as well as episodes of migraines. Foods such as walnuts, flax seeds, sesame seeds, almonds etc. help in meeting these requirements.

- Avoid deep fried, oily and spicy foods. They can trigger acidity and increase nausea and vomiting. In case of nausea and vomiting try to suck on a cardamom or chew on few fresh mints leaves and fennel seeds. These will help cool the system and reduce nausea and vomiting. You can also take mint and fennel seed tea post meals.

- Cold compress kept on the nape or forehead for a few minutes at a time also helps in reducing the intensity of the headache. Stay in a cool, quiet room with dim or no lights to reduce the sensory stimulation.

- Include Pranayam and meditation in your regular routine. Research has shown the efficacy of both these techniques in migraines. Also, remove some time regularly to indulge in exercise as well as hobbies. They help increase the feel-good hormones in the body and help manage the stressors of life.

- Lavender essential oil as well as peppermint essential oil diffusers can be used. Both these fragrances have a positive effect on the brain and are known to be calming and soothing. They stimulate the brain to relax and reduce the pain intensity.

- A drop of cow ghee massaged in the navel and instilled in the nostrils also helps in managing migraines very well.

- Establishing and sticking to a regular sleep and wake cycle is also very important. Avoid screens in bed and when waking up in the morning. Let the internal biological clock reset to nature.

Follow the above tips to better manage the menace of migraines!

You can follow Dietitian Nisha on Instagram for nutrition & fitness tips and live interactive sessions at – nurtiwellness.by.dt.nishas

We at My Powai are now taking our reader's queries related to Diet & Nutrition, which Ms. Nisha Singh will reply to in our forthcoming issues.

You can send your questions at:
dietnutrition.queries@gmail.com

(The writer is a gold medalist in Food & Nutrition with more than 12 years experience. She manages various ailments through lifestyle and dietary modifications and specializes in weight loss & management. She practices at 102, Crystal Center, Raheja Vihar, Powai or Smile Craft, 23, Annapurna Industrial estate, Opp. CCD, Ghatkopar East. For appointments: 022 2857 6537 Email: singhnisha@gmail.com)

Eat healthy. Stay healthy

Chef Sudhir Pai

As I received a lot of appreciation for the healthy recipes in the last issue, I've decided to dish you 2 more mouth-watering recipes that are extremely healthy and tasty. Needless to say they are easy to prepare too. So eat healthy and stay fit!

Hummus and vegetable rolls

2 Portions

For Hummus

Boiled chick peas	1 cup
Tahina paste(sesame paste)	2 tbsp.
Salt to taste	
Lime juice	2 tsp.
Chopped garlic	1 tsp.
Olive oil	1 tbsp.
Water	1 tbsp.
Ice	2 cubes

For the roll

Whole wheat wrap	2 no's
Hummus - Shredded lettuce	20 gms
Tomato juliennes	20 gms
Carrot juliennes	20 gms
Coloured pepper juliennes	20 gms
Onion slices	20 gms
Salt to taste	
Pepper pd	1/3 tsp.
Grated cheese	1 tbsp. (optional)

For grilling

Olive oil

Method

1. For hummus take all the ingredients with boiled chick peas and make into a fine paste
2. Slightly heat a wholewheat wrap on a tawa on both sides
3. Remove aside , spread hummus generously on it
4. Now spread the vegetable salad ingredients which are all mixed in advance
5. Sprinkle salt and pepper and roll the wrap tightly
6. Make two such rolls
7. Grill the rolls on a medium hot tawa using olive oil on all sides
8. Remove from tawa cut into 4 pcs each and serve with ketchup or chilli sauce

Beetroot and potato mini cakes

2 Portions

Roasted or boiled beetroot	2 no's
Boiled potato	2 no's
Salt to taste	
Chopped parsley	1 tsp.
Chopped green chilli	1 tsp.
Pepper powder	½ tsp.
Garam masala powder	1 tsp.
Flour for dusting	1 tbsp.

For grilling

Olive oil	1 tbsp.

For garnish

Parsley few sprigs	
Microgreens	6 no's

Method

1. Boil or roast beetroots for about 12 minutes , keep aside to cool
2. Peel the beetroot and grate them , take in a bowl
3. Add grated boiled potatoes, salt , garam masala powder , chopped parsley , chopped green chilli , pepper and mix well
4. Shape them into small cakes with your palm
5. Dust them with flour and grill them on both sides on a hot grill with olive oil
6. Serve hot garnished with parsley and micro green

Chef Sudhir Pai is a celebrated name in the F&B space with decades of experience in his portfolio. Right from working at the best hotels to creating iconic food brands to creating D2C packaged food brands to setting the perfect processes in all scales of food businesses, there is nothing in the F&B space he can't do. A people's person at heart, he has a great network of industry specialists and aces the role of consulting dozens of brands on their way to success. No project is impossible for his extensive skill set and expertise.)

August 2024

Richa Pathak

Aries (March 20 – April 18)
August brings new opportunities for Aries. Embrace changes at work with confidence. Spend quality time with your spouse to strengthen your bond. Prioritize mental health through mindfulness practices. Students should focus on setting achievable academic goals. Remedy: Carry a red jasper stone for courage. Lucky color: Red. Lucky days: Tuesday & Saturday

Taurus (April 19 – May 19)
Taurus natives can expect financial stability this month. New business ventures may be fruitful. Strengthen family ties through open communication. Maintain good health with regular exercise. Students should seek extra help in challenging subjects. Remedy: Burn cinnamon incense for prosperity. Lucky color: Green. Lucky days: Monday & Thursday

Gemini (May 20 – June 20)
August promises professional growth for Gemini individuals. Manage finances wisely to ensure stability. Foster harmony at home with patience and understanding. Engage in physical activities for better health. Students should participate in group studies for improved learning. Remedy: Wear or carry an agate stone for balance. Lucky color: Yellow. Lucky days: Wednesday & Sunday

Cancer (June 21 – July 21)
Cancerians will experience positive changes in their careers. Financial gains are likely, but avoid overspending. Focus on family harmony and support. Maintain physical health with a balanced diet. Students should stay motivated and seek new learning strategies. Remedy: Light a white candle for peace. Lucky color: Silver. Lucky days: Tuesday & Friday

Leo (July 22 – August 21)
Leo individuals can expect recognition and success in August. Overcome professional challenges with determination. Spend quality time with family to enhance emotional bonds. Prioritize digestive health with proper nutrition. Students should volunteer for personal growth. Remedy: Keep a sunstone for vitality. Lucky color: Orange. Lucky days: Monday & Thursday

Virgo (August 22 – September 21)
August brings prosperity and recognition for Virgo natives. Focus on financial planning for stability. Strengthen family bonds with shared activities. Address seasonal health concerns promptly. Students should remain focused on their academic goals. Remedy: Burn sandalwood incense for relaxation. Lucky color: Pink. Lucky days: Wednesday & Saturday

Libra (September 22 – October 22)
Librans may face professional challenges this month. Financial gains will provide relief. Prioritize self-care to manage stress. Maintain family harmony with understanding and compromise. Meditation can offer inner peace. Remedy: Carry a rose quartz for love and harmony. Lucky color: Blue. Lucky days: Tuesday & Friday

Scorpio (October 23 – November 20)
August brings opportunities for exploration and growth for Scorpios. Manage finances prudently during travels. Strengthen family bonds through quality time. Focus on bone health and seek medical advice if needed. Students should dedicate time to academic pursuits. Remedy: Wear or carry an obsidian stone for protection. Lucky color: Black. Lucky days: Monday & Thursday

Sagittarius (November 21 – Dec 20)
Sagittarians can expect financial gains and personal growth in August. Manage expenses wisely and reconnect with old friends. Exercise patience in family relationships. Academic endeavors show promise with dedication. Offer water to the sun god for positivity. Remedy: Keep a turquoise stone for luck and protection. Lucky color: Yellow. Lucky days: Wednesday & Sunday

Capricorn (December 21 – January 19)
August presents lucrative opportunities for Capricorn individuals. Prioritize relaxation and spend time with loved ones. Avoid financial risks and maintain physical well-being. Dedicate time to academic pursuits for success. Donate to charitable causes for positive vibes. Remedy: Burn jasmine incense for calmness. Lucky color: Brown. Lucky days: Tuesday & Friday

Aquarius (January 20 – February 18)
Aquarians can anticipate professional progress and personal growth in August. Show patience and understanding in relationships. Take care of paternal health and seek solace in spiritual practices. Participate in charitable activities for serenity. Remedy: Wear or carry a garnet stone for strength. Lucky color: Sky Blue. Lucky days: Thursday & Saturday

Pisces (February 19 – March 19)
August brings accolades and achievements for Pisces individuals. Maintain financial stability and foster positive relationships. Resolve family disputes harmoniously. Students should focus on skill enhancement. Engage in charitable activities for fulfillment. Remedy: Light a blue candle for peace of mind. Lucky color: Aqua. Lucky days: Monday & Friday

(Astrologer Richa Pathak masters the art of Astrology, Vastu & Numerology. In-person consultation with prior appointment can be done at 207, Lantana, Nahar Amrit Shakti, Chandivali, Powai. She also gives Virtual Consultation & can be reached @ 8452920640 & www.jyotishdham.com)